

Driftwatch — runtime visibility for cloud workloads

The Problem

Cloud security tooling scans configuration and code. It tells you what could go wrong. It does not tell you what is happening right now inside a running container.

The result is alert volume nobody can act on. A typical platform team receives several thousand findings a month, of which a small fraction correspond to anything reachable in production. Teams learn to ignore the queue, which is the worst possible outcome for a security control.

Our Solution

Driftwatch observes workloads at runtime using eBPF probes, with no sidecar and no code change. We see which processes actually execute, which libraries are actually loaded, and which network paths are actually used.

That turns a static finding into a real one. A critical vulnerability in a library that is installed but never loaded is not an emergency; the same vulnerability in a library handling inbound requests is. We can tell the difference, and the difference typically removes 80 to 90% of a team's queue.

We also detect drift: a container whose running state diverges from the image it was built from, which is the signature of both a compromise and a bad deployment.

The Market

Cloud workload protection is a \$4.8B market growing at around 20% a year. It is crowded and consolidating, with several large platforms acquiring runtime capability rather than building it.

We sell to platform and security engineering teams in companies running more than 200 containers in production.

Competition

The large cloud security platforms lead on breadth and on procurement. Their runtime components are generally bolted on and produce coarse signals. Several open-source projects cover parts of what we do, and we build on one of them.

Our differentiation is depth of runtime context and the correlation between what is running and what was scanned. We have published our probe overhead benchmarks, which competitors have not, because ours is under 1% of CPU and theirs is not.

The Team

Tomas Eriksen and Nadia Belkacem met building platform infrastructure at a logistics company, where they ran the Kubernetes estate and built internal tooling that became the first version of this product.

Neither comes from a security background. We have hired two senior detection engineers to close that gap, and we treat it as a real one: our advantage is in systems engineering, not in threat research.

Sixteen people.

Traction

- 43 paying customers, including four with over 10,000 containers
- \$2.8M annual recurring revenue, growing 9% month over month
- median alert volume reduction of 87% in the first month after deployment
- logo retention 95%, one churn in the last year
- 1,900 GitHub stars on our open-source probe library

Business Model

Consumption pricing based on monitored workload hours, with an annual commitment. Average contract value is \$65,000. Gross margin is 79%.

Consumption billing aligns cost to value but makes revenue less predictable than seats; about a fifth of our customers vary more than 20% month to month.

Go-To-Market

Inbound from the open-source library, converted by a small sales team. Average cycle is 11 weeks, extending to 20 for customers above 10,000 containers, where procurement and security review dominate.

Funding

We are raising \$14M to build the detection content library, hire into threat research, and pursue the compliance certifications that enterprise procurement now requires.